Zisel Jewelry

Competitive Playbook · Holiday Pop-Up 2026–27

Wholesale diamond & gold jewelry, custom pieces, private showings and showing parties · Las Vegas · Prepared Oct 10, 2026 (PT)

How to read this: plain text with a link is a sourced fact (prices as listed Oct 10, 2026). Anything tagged RECOMMENDATION or PROPOSAL is our advice, not a fact. **[PRICE]**, **[DATE]** and similar brackets are blanks only the owner can fill. No Zisel prices are given here because none have been set yet.

1 Bottom line

RECOMMENDATION Vegas already has plenty of jewelers selling "wholesale roots + private appointment" (Sky Diamonds, D&R House of Diamonds, The Jewelers of Las Vegas, The Diamond Store), and almost none of them post prices. The price anchors customers check come from online sellers (Blue Nile, Brilliant Earth, Kay). We found no Vegas fine jeweler marketing **showing parties**. Zisel should win as **"wholesale diamonds and gold, brought to your party."** That means four moves: (1) lead with showing parties and private showings; (2) back up the word "wholesale" with "from" prices on 5–8 hero pieces, each shown next to a named online comparison; (3) for the holidays, offer a **gift with purchase instead of a % discount**, because a discount undercuts "already wholesale"; (4) sell custom work against published order-by dates. **The timing catch:** custom for Hanukkah needs orders by **Oct 16**, which is before the Thanksgiving text blast (Nov 26). So for Hanukkah buyers reached by the blast, lead with **in-stock** pieces; pitch custom hardest for Christmas and Valentine's Day. Before the blast, the site needs real contact info, a booking picker, a trust strip, FTC-compliant diamond labels, and a dated Holiday Pop-Up section.

2 Competitive landscape

Tiers: **1** = Vegas local (direct competition) · **2** = online/mass retail (where customers price-check) · **3** = Strip luxury (price ceiling and design reference). The "Threat" column is our assessment.

Competitor	Tier · format	What they win on (sourced)	Threat to Zisel
Sky Diamonds	1 · Town Square showroom	Mizrahi family, 40+ yrs wholesaling to other jewelers, opened to public 2019; "Transparent value, no brand name markup"; natural + lab side by side; lifetime cleaning/sizing/appraisal; 4.8★ on 136 Yelp reviews that name staff, "no pressure"	**High.** Tells the same wholesale story, with a storefront and reviews to back it
D&R House of Diamonds	1 · Private office, Summerlin	By appointment only, meet the two owners, no sales staff; "low overhead = lower prices"; CAD custom with on-hand preview; "Best of Las Vegas" 9x (site); 4.9★ on ~200 reviews	**High.** The closest model to Zisel's private showings
The Jewelers of Las Vegas	1 · 3 locations	Family-owned since 1976, "wholesale jeweler," same-day appointments; RJ Best of Las Vegas every year since 2008; **no refunds** (90-day store credit)	**Med-High.** Already holds the "wholesale" label locally
MJ Christensen	1 · Summerlin + more	80+ yrs in Vegas; 4.9★ on ~2,500 Google reviews; designer brands; wax try-on for custom; events (Sparkle & Sip, Holiday Open House)	**Medium.** Owns reviews and in-store events, but doesn't compete on wholesale price
Dumoni Jewelers	1 · Downtown custom gold	**Public price menu** (4mm Cuban $1,650); simple custom 1–3 wks; Zelle/CashApp; Calendly booking; ~48.4K IG followers	**Medium.** Strongest on gold chains and custom gold
Jeffrey White	1 · Tivoli Village studio	Bespoke work; publishes timelines and holiday lead-time warnings	**Low-Med.** Mostly bridal and custom
Brilliant Earth	2 · Online DTC	Lab + natural side by side, IGI/GIA reports, free returns, lifetime warranty, Affirm 0% up to 36 mo, gift-with-purchase promos; no Vegas showroom	**High as a price anchor.** 3 ct lab tennis bracelet at $2,850
Blue Nile	2 · Online	Natural/lab toggle on every item, frequent % off, free overnight shipping, lifetime warranty	**High as a price anchor** for natural diamonds
Kay	2 · Mall (Meadows Mall)	Permanent markdowns ("35% off"), 30-day returns, lifetime lab-grown trade-in	**Medium.** Sets the anchor of lab studs under $910
Mejuri	2 · Online + boutiques	14k solid gold, 90% recycled, for everyday wear; 2-yr warranty; hosted Sip & Shop events (no fee at 40+ guests, 15% off)	**Medium.** Competes on gold basics and owns the event format

Competitor	Tier · format	What they win on (sourced)	Threat to Zisel
Strip luxury (Tiffany, Cartier, VCA)	3 · Wynn, Bellagio, Crystals, Forum Shops	Each owns one signature silhouette (Victoria, LOVE, Alhambra); heritage	**Low direct threat.** Sets the price ceiling (Victoria tennis $16,400)

Also in market: DiamondsNColors (private showroom, "call ahead"), T-Bird Jewels (4.9★/642), and the Meadows Mall cluster (listing). **Pattern:** Vegas independents compete on "importer/wholesale roots + private appointment + lifetime care" and almost never post prices.

3 Where Zisel wins

> **Positioning statement** RECOMMENDATION
>
> For Las Vegas gift-givers who want real diamonds and gold without retail markup, Zisel Jewelry brings a large wholesale inventory to a private showing or a party you host. Every piece is clearly labeled lab-grown or natural, and the prices hold up against Blue Nile and Brilliant Earth.

Pillar	Why it's open (sourced)	How to show it (recommendation)
1 · Showing parties	No Vegas fine jeweler we found markets them. The model belongs to direct-sales and costume brands (Park Lane, Touchstone) and to Mejuri's in-store Sip & Shop.	Make "Host a showing party" the hero CTA and the opening line of the text blast.
2 · Wholesale you can check	Every Vegas independent hides its prices while online sellers show theirs. Dumoni shows a public menu works locally.	Show "from $[PRICE]" next to a named comparison (e.g., Brilliant Earth $2,850).
3 · Two lanes, honestly labeled	Lab = more size per dollar (comparable stone ~$450 lab vs $2,800–3,200 natural at Brilliant Earth). Natural 1 ct now averages $3,898, down 51% since 2021 (CNBC).	Show both lanes side by side, as Sky Diamonds and Brilliant Earth do, with FTC wording on every piece.
4 · Holiday custom on a calendar	Custom runs 1–3 wks for simple pieces (Dumoni), +2–4 wks Nov–Feb (Jeffrey White). Luxury brands win on one recognizable motif.	Publish order-by dates (§5). Make the diamond-over-the-i a small "diamond dot" signature on clasps and pendants.

4 Website playbook (draft: sip-coder.github.io/zisel-jewelry)

Current state (seen Oct 10, 2026): the draft site has clean category cards (earrings, bracelets, necklaces, custom), a 3-step custom section, showing and party descriptions, and a Holiday Pop-Up block. Phone, dates, email and Instagram are still **[PLACEHOLDERS]**. There are no product prices or diamond labels yet, and the contact form says "we'll reach out" instead of booking a time. Every change below is our recommendation, drawn from Designer Daisy's 11-site teardown. RECOMMENDATION

When	Change	Why / model
P0	Fill every placeholder; put **hours · phone · "Las Vegas, by appointment"** at the top of every page	Sky Diamonds and Blue Nile both show the phone number in the header. Every texted link lands here
P0	Hero: **lead with showing parties + private showings**; two CTAs: "Book a private showing" · "Host a showing party"	Daisy: "do differently." Showing parties are white space
P0	**Real date-and-time booking picker** with service type (Private showing / Showing party / Custom consult) and SMS confirmation	Brilliant Earth flow (Fine Jewelry & Gifts 50 min); D&R uses Bookly, Dumoni uses Calendly
P0	**"Why our prices are wholesale"** block, 3 short lines (inventory source, no storefront/brand markup, private showings), worded only as the owner can confirm	Mirrors Sky's "Transparent Value, No Brand Name Markup" list
P0	**3-item trust strip,** e.g. "IGI/GIA report on center diamonds · Written warranty · Private, no-pressure showings." List only promises the owner will keep	Daisy recommendation; trust norms in §7
P0	**Dated Holiday Pop-Up section:** Hanukkah Dec 4–12 · Christmas Dec 25 · Valentine's Feb 14, with order-by dates, RSVP-by-text and showing dates	Daisy: give the pop-up its own dated section
P0	**5–8 product cards** to Daisy's spec: name → "laboratory-grown diamond" / "natural diamond" line + IGI/GIA badge → "from $[PRICE]" (optional "online: $X at [retailer]") → fallback "wholesale price at your showing"	FTC disclosure (§7); proves the "wholesale" claim
P0	QA (done on live site): non-breaking hyphen on "Holiday Pop-Up"; wordmark has aria-label="Zisel Jewelry" and aria-hidden glyph spans	Fixed Oct 10
Later	Gift navigation by price tier (Under $[X] / $[Y] / $[Z]+)	Catbird; Daisy recommendation

When	Change	Why / model
Later	Testimonials with first name + piece (+ city) once real reviews exist; never write placeholder reviews	The Fine Diamond; Sky reviews name staff
Later	"Drop a hint" button, SMS/email sign-up, custom CAD-preview gallery, financing note, virtual showing	Brilliant Earth, D&R, Blue Nile
Avoid	Promo-code banners, mega-menus, heavy all-caps type, SEO neighborhood lists	Daisy teardown

5 Jewelry & collection playbook

Launch assortment (recommendation): a short hero edit, not a catalog (final mix depends on Ben's inventory)

Category	Hero items	Lab vs natural	Gold karat	Demand signal
Bracelets	**Tennis bracelet, 2–3 ct tw** (hero of the whole pop-up)	Both: lab for size per dollar, natural for heritage buyers	14k white + yellow	#1 holiday gift (National Jeweler via Beyond Two Rings)
Earrings	**1 ct tw studs**; diamond huggies; sculptural gold hoops	Studs in both lanes; huggies lab	14k	Studs are the "first fine-jewelry gift"; huggies are beating plain hoops (Dainty London, Whiteflash)
Necklaces	**Tennis/rivière necklace**; diamond pendant (bezel, pear); 14k chains: **Cuban**, rope, paperclip	Lab for the necklace; pendant in both	14k; 10k / semi-solid entry chains; 18k premium	Cuban is the dominant chain in Vegas (Nevada Coin Mart); paperclip, herringbone and rope trend (Brilliant Earth)
Holiday motifs	Star of David, cross, initial, heart pendants; "eight nights" Hanukkah set (small pieces plus one bigger)	Either	14k	OD's, AJLuxe
Signature	"Diamond dot" detail (from the logo's diamond-i) on clasps and pendants	Lab	14k	Luxury brands each own one silhouette (§2)

Karat facts: 10k = 41.7% gold (most durable and affordable); **14k = 58.3%, "the sweet spot"**; 18k = 75% (Dumoni). Gold spot was **$4,195.60/oz on Oct 9, 2026** (Gold Market Daily). RECOMMENDATION Quote chains by weight and solidity, and hold each quote for a short, stated window.

Price anchors Zisel must visibly beat (listed prices, Oct 10, 2026)

Zisel item	Comparable (spec)	Price to beat	Source
1 ct tw studs, lab	Kay, 14KW F/SI2 (out of stock)	**$909.99** (was $1,399.99)	Kay
1 ct tw studs, natural	Blue Nile six-prong / halo, 14KW H-I/SI	**$2,674** sale ($3,820 list) / **$1,785** sale	six-prong · halo
Tennis bracelet, lab 3 ct	Brilliant Earth 6", 14KW F/G VS, IGI	**$2,850**	Brilliant Earth
Tennis bracelet, lab promo	Van Adams Black Friday 2025, 2 ct / 3 ct	**$1,295 / $1,595**	Van Adams
Tennis bracelet, natural 2 ct	Blue Nile 7", 14KW H-I/SI	**$3,730**	Blue Nile
Tennis bracelet, natural fine	Mejuri 1.3 mm, ~0.82–1.03 ct, 14k YG	**from $2,600**	Mejuri
14k chain	Kay rope, semi-solid, 18", 2.4 mm	**$844.99** (was $1,299.99)	Kay
14k chain	Mejuri round box, solid, 2.5 mm, 20"	**from $1,900**	Mejuri
14k Cuban chain (local)	Dumoni 4 mm	**$1,650**	Dumoni
Diamond pendant (promo)	Van Adams petite 14k pendant	**$495** (from $695)	Van Adams
Luxury ceiling	Tiffany Victoria tennis, platinum, 1.82 ct	**$16,400**	Tiffany

RECOMMENDATION Compare like for like: same carat weight, color/clarity, karat and solid vs semi-solid. Local promos already put 3 ct lab tennis bracelets at $1,595, so a lab tennis price that looks "wholesale" has to come in under that number, not just under Brilliant Earth.

Custom offer and order-by dates (proposal)

PROPOSAL **"Holiday Custom":** bring a sketch, photo or description. Zisel provides a CAD preview (as D&R does), takes a deposit credited to the final price (Dumoni uses $1,000; Zisel's amount is the owner's call), and the customer pays the balance at pickup. Focus on simple pieces

(initials, pendants, chain builds, earrings). The dates below assume 1–3 wks of work (Dumoni) plus 2–4 wks of holiday load (Jeffrey White). The owner must confirm them against Ben's or the maker's real lead times.

Holiday	Safe order-by (7 wks)	Latest (3 wks)	Note
Hanukkah (first night Fri Dec 4; ends Sat Dec 12, 2026)	**Fri Oct 16**	Fri Nov 13	Custom by Oct 16 is before the pre-Thanksgiving blast. Buyers reached by the blast get **in-stock** pieces; warm contacts can still order custom early
Christmas (Fri Dec 25, 2026)	**Fri Nov 6**	Fri Dec 4	The blast lands after the safe date, so lead the custom pitch with "order by Dec 4"
Valentine's Day (Sun Feb 14, 2027)	**Sun Dec 27**	Sun Jan 24	In-stock cutoff ~Feb 11 (market norm Feb 11–12, USA Today)

6 Showing parties & holiday promo (all proposals)

Host reward ladder: pick one option

Option	Mechanic	Benchmark (sourced)	Trade-off
A · Credit ladder	Host earns jewelry credit as a % of party sales, rising with sales tier (e.g., 10% → 15% → 20% at owner-set thresholds), plus one host pick at half price	Fine-jewelry trunk shows 10–20% in jewelry (search summary, unverified); Touchstone 15–25% credit + half-price picks	Scales with results; simple to explain
B · Gift ladder	A fixed host gift at each sales tier: Tier 1 [$X] → 14k gold piece; Tier 2 [$Y] → lab studs; Tier 3 [$Z] → lab tennis bracelet	The Finery House: 3 ct lab diamond host gift at $20k in sales	Feels the most "fine jewelry"; set costs per tier
C · Guest-count perk	Host gift unlocked by attendance and orders (e.g., [N] + guests or [N]+ orders), plus credit	Park Lane: $35 favorite + $40 credit at 10+ orders; Mejuri: no fee at 40+ guests	Drives turnout; weakest link to revenue

RECOMMENDATION **Option A, paid out in lab-grown or gold product rather than cash.** Lab gross margins run 60–65% vs 40–45% for naturals (CNBC), so the same reward costs Zisel less. Add a "book your own party" bonus for any guest who books a date.

Holiday Sip & Shop concept

PROPOSAL **"Zisel Holiday Pop-Up: Sip & Shop."** Evening showings at Ben's showroom or a host's home, modeled on MJ Christensen's "Sparkle & Sip" (events) and Mejuri's Dec 2–11 Sip & Shop.

- **Three dated windows:** Hanukkah/early-gift night right after the blast (week of Nov 30, before Dec 4) · Christmas night (mid-Dec, before Dec 25) · Valentine's night (early Feb, before Feb 11). Owner sets the exact **[DATES]**.
- **Format:** RSVP by text; 1:1 time slots inside the event (as The Finery House does); the hero edit from §5 on trays labeled lab/natural; a custom-consult corner showing the order-by dates.
- **Offer: a gift with purchase, not % off,** e.g., free lab studs over **[$ threshold]**. Market examples: Brilliant Earth gave ½ ct lab studs over $1,000 (StyleCaster); Van Adams 1 ct lab studs over $1,000; Arden studs over $2,000.
- **List-building:** "Drop a hint" cards and an SMS sign-up at the door (Brilliant Earth uses sign-up sweepstakes). Every guest is a potential future host.

7 Compliance & trust must-dos

- **FTC lab-grown wording (required):** put "laboratory-grown," "laboratory-created" or "[manufacturer]-created" **right next to the word "diamond"**, clearly and conspicuously. A note in an FAQ or a hashtag may not be enough. This covers the **website, texts, flyers and social posts** (FTC). RECOMMENDATION Label naturals "natural diamond" on every card as well.
- **Grading reports: IGI for lab, GIA for natural** is the norm. Since Oct 1, 2025, GIA no longer gives D–Z/clarity grades for lab-grown stones, only "Premium"/"Standard" (National Jeweler, GIA). RECOMMENDATION Show the IGI/GIA badge only on pieces that actually come with a report.
- **Warranty:** the bar is lifetime product warranty (Blue Nile, Brilliant Earth), lifetime craftsmanship (Dumoni), 2 yrs (Mejuri), and lifetime cleaning/sizing/appraisal (Sky). RECOMMENDATION Offer a written warranty plus free cleaning, and put it in the trust strip.
- **Returns:** online sets the bar at free 30-day returns (Brilliant Earth, Kay). Locals are stricter: The Jewelers gives no refunds, only a 90-day store-credit exchange. Custom is final sale almost everywhere. RECOMMENDATION Publish one short written policy (an exchange window for in-stock pieces; custom final sale) and hand it out at every showing.

- **Payments/financing:** Brilliant Earth offers Affirm 0% up to 36 mo, Wells Fargo 12-mo, layaway, and 1.5% off for wire. Dumoni takes Zelle/CashApp (BE, Dumoni). RECOMMENDATION Decide before the first party; deposit terms for custom need to be in writing.
- **Claims:** RECOMMENDATION Back up "wholesale pricing" and "massive wholesale inventory" with the visible comparisons in §5 and with what Ben actually makes available. Confirm the legal spelling of the brand before printing (the brief lists it as unverified; the site uses "Zisel"). The owner has an EIN and a Nevada business license (brief).

8 Owner decisions needed

Decision	Options	Our recommendation	Needed by
Show prices online?	None · "from" prices · full menu	"From $[PRICE]" on 5–8 heroes, with the "wholesale price at your showing" fallback for everything else	Before blast
Actual hero prices	Set per item from Ben's inventory	Each must beat its §5 anchor on a like-for-like spec	Before blast
Order-by dates	Confirm the maker's real lead times	Use or adjust the §5 dates; print them on the site and in the texts	Before blast
Contact & location	Phone, hours, IG, email, booking link; name Ben's showroom or not	Text-first phone + booking link; "Las Vegas, by appointment" if the address stays private	Before blast
Photos	Ben's inventory · on-model · none yet	Real photos of the 5–8 heroes; launch the cards with the price fallback if photos lag	Before blast
Lab vs natural mix	By category	Both lanes on tennis and studs; lab for necklaces, huggies and host rewards	Before first party
Host rewards	Options A / B / C (§6)	A, paid in lab/gold product	Before first party
Holiday offer	Gift with purchase vs % off	Gift with purchase over a set threshold; no promo codes	Before blast
Policies	Warranty, returns/exchange, deposit, financing/payments	One written page, linked on the site and handed out at showings	Before first sale
Brand spelling	Zisel / Ziesel / other	Lock it once and use it everywhere	Now

9 Sources

Research files: zisel_product_competitor_research.md, competitors.csv, zisel_business_marketing.md, brief.md (all checked Oct 10, 2026); Designer Daisy's 11-site website teardown (internal). Cartier/VCA prices come from a secondary tracker, and the trunk-show % is from a search summary; both are flagged in the research.

1. Sky Diamonds
2. Sky Diamonds (home/reviews)
3. Sky Yelp (Apple Maps)
4. The Jewelers of LV FAQ
5. The Jewelers custom
6. D&R House of Diamonds
7. D&R reviews
8. DiamondsNColors
9. The Diamond Store
10. MJ Christensen custom
11. MJ Christensen events
12. Local listings
13. Jeffrey White timeline
14. Dumoni custom
15. Dumoni chains
16. Dumoni IG tracker
17. Nevada Coin Mart
18. Brilliant Earth lab tennis/promos
19. Brilliant Earth trends
20. Blue Nile studs (six-prong)
21. Blue Nile studs (halo)
22. Blue Nile tennis
23. Mejuri tennis
24. Mejuri chain
25. Mejuri events
26. Mejuri holiday Sip & Shop
27. Kay lab studs
28. Kay rope chain
29. Tiffany Victoria
30. Tiffany LV stores
31. Shops at Wynn
32. Cartier price tracker
33. VCA price tracker
34. Van Adams Black Friday
35. Arden Jewelers
36. StyleCaster (BE Black Friday)
37. CNBC diamond prices
38. JCK lab prices
39. Gold Market Daily
40. Beyond Two Rings / National Jeweler
41. Dainty London
42. Whiteflash 2026
43. Marie Claire 2026
44. AJLuxe Hanukkah 2026
45. OD's Jewellers
46. Samuelson's (Valentine's)
47. USA Today Valentine's
48. Park Lane host
49. Touchstone hosting
50. The Finery House
51. Trunk-show summary
52. FTC Jewelry Guides
53. National Jeweler (GIA)
54. GIA terminology
55. Zisel draft site